Course milestone M12: Presentation Planning: Your Audience, Your Pitches, and Your Questions

HONR 46400 · Evidence-Driven Research

What to submit

One file, `lastname_m12.pdf`. Everything this milestone asks for goes inside it, as sections in the order below.

Submit it on Brightspace, under **Assignments** then **M12**. Brightspace carries the deadline.

What to do

Your presentation plan

Your poster is printed. From here the research is spoken: at the Expo you stand next to the board and talk to people who did not come for you. This milestone is the plan for that conversation. Your pitches get a live test before the Expo: in class, you present your poster to the room as a practice run, and your classmates ask you the questions they prepared in their peer review. The course schedule names the day.

What goes in your file, in this order

1. **Your audience.** One paragraph on who will stop at your poster (students, faculty from other fields, people who know your topic, judges, family and friends), what they already know or believe about your question, and what they would do with your answer. Then two or three key points that will resonate with them.
2. **Three elevator pitches**, written as scripts, each with its word count shown:
   - **30 seconds, at most 75 words**: your title, your question, and why it matters, with your headline at its true size;
   - **90 seconds, at most 200 words**: adds your design and method in brief, your key result with its uncertainty, and why it matters;
   - **2 minutes, at most 300 words**: the question, the design and method, the result, your interpretation, the main limitation, your next step, and where the finding could matter in the world.

   The **boundary sentence**, the one line saying where your evidence stops, appears at all three lengths, in the same words. Compression drops blocks, never bounds. Read each pitch aloud with a timer.
3. **Poster integration.** For each pitch, the block of your poster your hand points at, and when; then a short outline of how you move between sections.
4. **Question and discussion strategy.** How you will invite questions; three questions you expect, each with a one-sentence answer and marked as a bound request or an attack; at least three questions you will ask your audience; and one prepared "my design cannot settle that", with the smaller true claim your evidence does support.
5. **Your Round 02 mentor meeting, confirmed.** The date and time, who attended, what the meeting changed, and what you carried from it into this plan. If the meeting did not happen, say so, with the reason.
6. **Your AI Research Ledger rows** for this milestone, or "No AI used".

How it is graded

A 100-point rubric, shown below band by band; the same rubric is attached to this assignment as a PDF. Each criterion is scored in one band, the band's points are a range, and the grade falls inside it. Check your plan against it before you submit.

Criterion	Excellent	Proficient	Developing	Inadequate
Audience analysis (15 pts)	**14–15 pts:** Names the audience you will actually meet, what they already believe, and what they will do with your answer; the key	**11–13 pts:** Clear audience, one key point generic	**6–10 pts:** Audience described in general terms only ("the public")	**0–5 pts:** No audience analysis

Criterion	Excellent	Proficient	Developing	Inadequate
	points are specific to that audience and visibly shape the pitches			
The three pitches (25 pts)	**23–25 pts:** All three written, rehearsed, and within their ceilings with counts shown; each does its own job instead of being a cut-down version of the next; clear and concise enough to say without reading	**18–22 pts:** Within ceilings; one version doing the wrong job or hard to say aloud	**10–17 pts:** Over a ceiling, or one version missing	**0–9 pts:** Pitches not written or not counted
Bound discipline under compression (25 pts)	**23–25 pts:** The boundary sentence is present and identical at all three lengths; no word is stronger in a short version than in a long one, or stronger than on the poster	**18–22 pts:** One soft word creeps in at thirty seconds	**10–17 pts:** A short version drops the bound	**0–9 pts:** A short version states a stronger claim than the evidence licenses
Poster integration (10 pts)	**9–10 pts:** The block your hand points at is named for each length, and the transitions follow the poster's reading order	**7–8 pts:** Integration named for most lengths	**4–6 pts:** Integration vague ("I point at the poster")	**0–3 pts:** No poster integration
Question and discussion strategy (15 pts)	**14–15 pts:** A concrete way to invite questions; predicted questions derived from your design and typed correctly; audience-directed questions that would really produce information; a prepared concession that is true, with a real smaller claim	**11–13 pts:** Complete; one question generic	**6–10 pts:** Questions plausible but not derived from your design, or fewer than three of a kind	**0–5 pts:** No prepared concession, or one that gives away more than the evidence
Craft, ledger & Round 02 confirmation (10 pts)	**9–10 pts:** Plan readable and complete; ledger rows name real verification steps; the Round 02 confirmation reports what changed and what you carried forward	**7–8 pts:** Complete; one ledger row loose or the carry-over line thin	**4–6 pts:** Ledger thin, or the meeting confirmation incomplete	**0–3 pts:** Missing AI Research Ledger (scored 0, submission returned)
Total	**100 points**			

A missing AI Research Ledger scores the last row 0 and returns the plan for completion before it is graded.